QUICK GUIDE

# SAWTOOTH WAVE

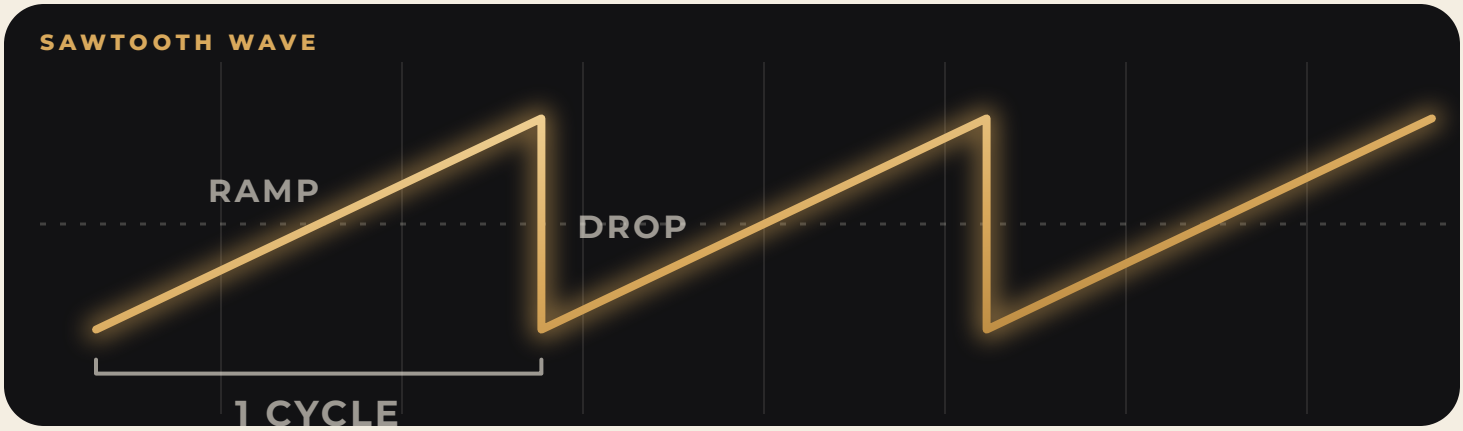
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

## WHAT IT IS

A sawtooth wave rises in a straight line, then drops sharply back to the start. It contains every harmonic, both even and odd.

## HOW IT SOUNDS

Bright, thick and buzzy. The classic big synth sound.




### 01

**RAMP AND DROP**

Rises in a line, then falls straight down. Like saw teeth.

### 02

**ALL THE HARMONICS**

The richest of the basic shapes.

### 03

**BUILT FOR LEADS AND BASS**

Big synths, stabs and thick bass lines start here.

## DO THIS TONIGHT

***Bright, thick sounds need space. Don't stack two on one beat.***

- [ ] When a lead or bass sounds thick and bright, think saw.
- [ ] Don't stack two bright sounds on the same beat.
- [ ] Open a filter slowly to bring a saw in.





PRACTICE & CHECK

# SAWTOOTH WAVE: YOUR TURN

## WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Supersaw leads and big EDM stabs.
- Thick bass lines.
- A great source for filter sweeps, because there's so much for the filter to shape.

## QUICK CHECK

**1. Which harmonics does a saw wave contain?**

**2. What does a saw wave look like?**

**3. Why are saw sounds good for filter sweeps?**

**Answer key:** 1) All of them, even and odd. 2) A ramp that drops sharply. 3) They have lots of harmonics for the filter to shape.

REMEMBER

***Ramp up, drop down. Every harmonic. Big and bright.***

## YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Pulse Wave



